

Chapter 2: Sources of History

Textbook Exercise Solutions & Answers

1. Answer in one sentence:

Q1.) In the past, what materials were used for writing?

In the past, writing materials included potsherds, unbaked bricks, the bark of birch trees (bhurjapatra), and copper plates.

Q2.) What information is obtained from Vedic literature?

Vedic literature provides rich information about ancient Indian history, culture, religion, and the day-to-day life of the people.

Q3.) Which literature is preserved by oral tradition?

Folk literature such as owis, folk songs, folk tales, and early Vedic compositions was preserved across generations through oral tradition.

2. Classify the following sources as material, written and oral sources:

Copper-plate, folk tales, pottery, beads, travelogues, owis, inscriptions, Vedic literature, stupa, coin, Puranas

Material Sources	Written Sources	Oral Sources
• Pottery • Beads • Stupa • Coins	• Copper-plate • Inscriptions • Travelogues • Vedic literature • Puranas	• Folk tales • Owis

3. Observe the picture of earthen pots and try to make similar ones:

(Activity Note) Students should observe the shapes, rims, and ancient decorative patterns of historical earthen pots and craft small clay models using potter's clay or modeling clay, attempting to replicate the traditional geometric and natural motifs.

4. Observe any coin and note the following things:

- **Inscription on the coin:** Picture / Title of Queen Victoria (or sovereign authority).
- **Metal used:** Gold (or Silver / Nickel / Bronze depending on coin studied).
- **Year of the coin:** 1862.
- **Symbol / Portrait on the coin:** Royal bust / emblem.
- **Language, shape, and denomination:** English inscription, circular/round shape, denomination struck according to standard coin specification.